

Wine Pronunciation Guide

Grapes · Regions · Terms · Famous Estates — How to Say It Correctly

Each entry shows the phonetic spelling and the origin language. Common mistakes are noted where relevant. For audio pronunciation, use the interactive tool at kazmicellars.com

Red Grapes	
Cabernet Sauvignon KAB-er-nay so-VIN-yohn <i>French · The final 't' is silent</i>	Merlot mer-LOH <i>French · Never 'mer-LOT' — the 't' is always silent</i>
Pinot Noir PEE-noh NWAHR <i>French · Noir rhymes with 'war'</i>	Syrah see-RAH <i>French · Same grape as Shiraz — name changes by region</i>
Grenache greh-NAHSH <i>French · Called Garnacha in Spain</i>	Garnacha gar-NAH-chah <i>Spanish · Spanish name for Grenache</i>
Tempranillo tem-prah-NEE-yoh <i>Spanish · Double 'l' sounds like 'y' in Spanish</i>	Sangiovese san-joh-VAY-zeh <i>Italian · Backbone of Chianti, Brunello, and Morellino</i>
Nebbiolo neh-BYOH-loh <i>Italian · From 'nebbia' — Italian for fog</i>	Malbec MAL-bek <i>French · Called Cot in Loire, Auxerrois in Cahors</i>
Cabernet Franc KAB-er-nay FRONK <i>French · 'Franc' rhymes with 'bronze' not 'frank'</i>	Zinfandel ZIN-fan-del <i>English · Genetically identical to Italian Primitivo</i>
Primitivo pree-mee-TEE-voh <i>Italian · Southern Italian name for Zinfandel</i>	Mourvèdre moor-VED-ruh <i>French · Called Monastrell in Spain</i>
Monastrell mon-ah-STREL <i>Spanish · Spanish name for Mourvèdre</i>	Barbera bar-BAIR-ah <i>Italian · Common mistake: bar-BEAR-ah</i>
Gamay gah-MAY <i>French · The grape of Beaujolais</i>	Aglianico ah-LYAH-nee-koh <i>Italian · The 'gl' sounds like 'ly' — common mispronunciation</i>
Nero d'Avola NEH-roh DAH-voh-lah <i>Italian · Sicily's flagship red grape</i>	Carménère kar-meh-NAIR <i>French · Chile's defining grape — originally from Bordeaux</i>
Corvina kor-VEE-nah <i>Italian · Primary grape in Amarone and Valpolicella</i>	Nerello Mascalese neh-REL-loh mas-kah-LAY-zeh <i>Italian · The great red grape of Mount Etna, Sicily</i>

Xinomavro KSEE-noh-MAH-vroh <i>Greek · Means 'acid black' — Greece's greatest red</i>	Agiorgitiko ah-your-YEE-tee-koh <i>Greek · Also called Saint George's grape — from Nemea</i>
Touriga Nacional toh-REE-gah nah-syoh-NAHL <i>Portuguese · The soul of Vintage Port</i>	

White Grapes	
Chardonnay shar-doh-NAY <i>French · World's most planted white — from Burgundy</i>	Sauvignon Blanc SOH-veen-yohn BLONK <i>French · The 'c' in Blanc is silent</i>
Riesling REEZ-ling <i>German · Never 'RICE-ling' — a very common mistake</i>	Pinot Gris PEE-noh GREE <i>French · Alsace style — full-bodied and rich</i>
Pinot Grigio PEE-noh GREE-joh <i>Italian · Italian style — light and crisp</i>	Gewurztraminer geh-VURTS-trah-mee-ner <i>German · Means 'spicy grape from Tramin'</i>
Viognier vee-oh-NYAY <i>French · Common mistake: vee-OG-nee-ay</i>	Chenin Blanc SHEH-nan BLONK <i>French · The great white of the Loire Valley</i>
Albariño al-bah-REE-nyoh <i>Spanish · The n with tilde sounds like 'ny'</i>	Grüner Veltliner GR00-ner FELT-lee-ner <i>German · Austria's flagship white grape</i>
Assyrtiko ah-SEER-tee-koh <i>Greek · Santorini's great volcanic white grape</i>	Vermentino ver-men-TEE-noh <i>Italian · The coastal Mediterranean white</i>
Muscat MUS-kat <i>French · Called Moscato in Italy</i>	Moscato mos-KAH-toh <i>Italian · Moscato d'Asti is gently sweet and low alcohol</i>
Furmint FOOR-mint <i>Hungarian · The soul of Tokaji — very high natural acid</i>	Marsanne mar-SAN <i>French · The richer of the two Rhone whites</i>
Roussanne roo-SAN <i>French · The more aromatic of the two Rhone whites</i>	Verdicchio ver-DIK-ee-oh <i>Italian · Central Italian white from Marche</i>
Garganega gar-GAH-neh-gah <i>Italian · The grape behind Soave Classico</i>	

French Regions & Terms

Terroir

tair -WAHR

French · No direct English translation — sense of place

Sommelier

sum -el -YAY

French · Often mispronounced 'SOM-el-yay'

Chateau

sha -TOH

French · Plural: Chateaux — also sha-TOH

Bourgogne

boor -GON -yuh

French · French name for Burgundy

Bordeaux

bor -DOH

French · The 'x' is silent — never bor-DOX

Pauillac

poh -YAK

French · Home to Lafite, Latour, Mouton Rothschild

Margaux

mar -GOH

French · The 'x' at the end is silent

Medoc

may -DOK

French · The Left Bank peninsula of Bordeaux

Saint-Emilion

san -ay -meeL -YOHN

French · Right Bank — home to Petrus and Cheval Blanc

Pomerol

pom -eh -ROHL

French · Tiny appellation — home to Petrus

Beaujolais

boh -zhoh -LAY

French · The 's' at the end is silent

Meursault

mer -SOH

French · Home to great white Burgundy

Puligny-Montrachet

poo -lee -NYEE **mon** -rah -SHAY

French · Both the 't' and final 'ch' are silent

Chablis

sha -BLEE

French · The 's' is silent — pure unoaked Chardonnay

Chateauneuf-du-Pape

sha -toh -nuf -doo -PAP

French · 'New castle of the Pope'

Cote-Rotie

coat roh -TEE

French · 'Roasted slope' — great Northern Rhone Syrah

Condrieu

kon -dree -UH

French · The definitive home of Viognier

Hermitage

er -mee -TAHZH

French · The 'H' is silent in French

Alsace

aL -ZAS

French · The final 'e' is silent

Vouvray

voo -VRAY

French · Loire Chenin Blanc — dry through to sweet

Sancerre

son -SAIR

French · Home to France's finest Sauvignon Blanc

Pouilly-Fume

poo -YEE **foo** -MAY

French · Not to be confused with Pouilly-Fuisse (Chardonnay)

Champagne

sham -PAN -yuh

French · In French: sham-PAN-yuh — not sham-PAIN

Sauternes

soh -TAIRN

French · The 's' at the end is silent

Negociant

nay -goh -SYOHN

French · A merchant who buys and sells wine

Domaine

doh -MAIN

French · An estate that grows its own grapes

Grand Cru GROHN KROO <i>French · 'Great growth' — the highest classification</i>	Premier Cru preh-MYAY KROO <i>French · 'First growth' — second tier in Burgundy</i>
Vendange von-DOHNZH <i>French · The harvest</i>	Eleuage ay-luh-VAHZH <i>French · The raising or aging of wine in barrel</i>

Italian Regions & Terms

Barolo bah-ROH-loh <i>Italian · 'The King of wines' — Nebbiolo from Piedmont</i>	Barbaresco bar-bah-RES-koh <i>Italian · Nebbiolo's more elegant sibling</i>
Brunello di Montalcino broo-NEL-loh dee mon-tal-CHEE-noh <i>Italian · 5+ years aging required before release</i>	Chianti Classico kee-AHN-tee KLAS-ee-koh <i>Italian · The heartland Chianti — Gallo Nero logo</i>
Amarone ah-mah-ROH-neh <i>Italian · From dried grapes — means 'the bitter one'</i>	Valpolicella val-pol-ee-CHEL-lah <i>Italian · Lighter Corvina-based red from Veneto</i>
Prosecco proh-SEK-oh <i>Italian · Italian sparkling — Glera grape, not Champagne method</i>	Sassicaia sas-ee-KAY-ah <i>Italian · The original Super Tuscan</i>
Tignanello teen-yah-NEL-loh <i>Italian · Antinori's famous Super Tuscan blend</i>	Ornellaia or-nel-LYE-ah <i>Italian · Bolgheri estate — home of Masseto Merlot</i>
Soave SWAH-veh <i>Italian · Garganega-based white from Veneto</i>	Dolcetto dol-CHET-toh <i>Italian · Piedmont red — means 'little sweet one'</i>
Frascati fras-KAH-tee <i>Italian · Rome's local white wine</i>	

Spanish & Portuguese

Rioja ree-OH-hah <i>Spanish · The 'j' sounds like an 'h' — ree-OH-hah</i>	Ribera del Duero ree-BAIR-ah del DWAIR-oh <i>Spanish · Spain's Napa Valley — Tempranillo country</i>
Priorat pree-oh-RAHT <i>Catalan · Garnacha on black slate — llicorella</i>	Rias Baixas REE-as BY-shas <i>Galician · 'Baixas' is Galician for 'lower'</i>
Cava KAH-vah <i>Spanish · Spanish sparkling wine — traditional method</i>	Jerez heh-RETH <i>Spanish · Sherry country — the 'j' sounds like 'h'</i>

Manzanilla man-tha-NEE-yah Spanish · Dry Sherry from Sanlucar — saline and delicate	Verdejo ver-DEH-hoh Spanish · Rueda's white grape
Vinho Verde VEEN-yoh VAIR-deh Portuguese · Means 'green wine' — fresh, Atlantic style	Douro DOH-roh Portuguese · Port wine's home river and region

German & Austrian

Spatelse SHPAYT-lay-zeh German · 'Late harvest' — riper, slightly richer Riesling	Auslese OWS-lay-zeh German · 'Selected harvest' — often off-dry or sweet
Beerenauslese BAIR-en-OWS-lay-zeh German · 'Berry selected harvest' — sweet botrytis	Trockenbeerenauslese TROK-en-BAIR-en-OWS-lay-zeh German · The ultimate German sweet wine designation
Eiswein ICE-vine German · 'Ice wine' — made from frozen grapes	Kabinett kah-bee-NET German · Lightest Pradikat — delicate, low alcohol
Trocken TROK-en German · Bone dry — on a German wine label	Mosel MOH-zel German · The river and region — slate soils, elegant Riesling
Rheingau RINE-gow German · The Rhine bend — classic Riesling country	Wachau VAH-khow German · Austrian Danube valley — finest Gruner Veltliner
Smaragd smah-RAHGT German · Highest Wachau quality tier — named after a lizard	

Winemaking Terms

Tannin TAN-in English · Polyphenols from grape skins — creates drying feel	Malolactic mal-oh-LAK-tik English · Converts sharp malic acid to soft lactic acid
Botrytis boh-TRY-tis English · Noble rot — concentrates sugars for sweet wine	Phylloxera fil-LOK-ser-ah English · The louse that destroyed Europe's vineyards in 1800s
Maceration mas-er-AY-shun English · Skin contact — extracts colour, tannin, and flavour	Lees LEEZ English · Dead yeast cells — sur lie aging adds texture
Sur Lie sur LEE French · Aging wine on its lees — adds creaminess	Dosage doh-ZAHZH French · Sugar added to Champagne after disgorgement

Disgorgement dis-GORJ-ment <i>English · Removing frozen sediment plug from Champagne</i>	Elelage ay-luh-VAHZH <i>French · The raising or aging of wine</i>
Brut BROOT <i>French · Dry Champagne — less than 12g/L residual sugar</i>	Demi-Sec deh-mee SEK <i>French · Half-dry — actually noticeably sweet on the palate</i>
Appellation ah-pel-AY-shun <i>English · Legally defined geographic wine region</i>	Millesime mee-lay-SEEM <i>French · Vintage year — a millesime Champagne is vintage-dated</i>
Varietal var-EYE-eh-tal <i>English · Wine named after a single grape variety</i>	Barrique bah-REEK <i>French · 225-litre French oak barrel</i>
Negociant nay-goh-SYOHN <i>French · A merchant who buys grapes or wine to sell</i>	

Famous Estates & Wines

Romanee-Conti ro-mah-NAY CON-tee <i>French · The world's most expensive wine — 1.8 ha monopole</i>	Petrus PAY-troos <i>French · Pomerol's iconic Merlot — often the priciest Bordeaux</i>
Mouton Rothschild moo-TOHN ROHTS-child <i>French · Only chateau elevated to First Growth (1973)</i>	Haut-Brion oh-bree-YOHN <i>French · Only non-Medoc First Growth — from Pessac-Leognan</i>
Lafite Rothschild lah-FEET ROHTS-child <i>French · The 'te' in Lafite is silent</i>	Chateau d'Yquem sha-TOH dee-KEM <i>French · World's greatest sweet wine — Premier Cru Superieur</i>
Sassicaia sas-ee-KAY-ah <i>Italian · The Super Tuscan that changed Italian wine</i>	Tignanello teen-yah-NEL-loh <i>Italian · Antinori's pioneering Super Tuscan</i>
Vega Sicilia VAY-gah see-THEEL-ee-ah <i>Spanish · Spain's most celebrated wine estate</i>	Domaine Leroy doh-MAIN luh-RWAH <i>French · DRC's great Burgundy rival — Lalou Bize-Leroy</i>
Condrieu kon-dree-UH <i>French · The definitive home of Viognier</i>	Gaja GAH-yah <i>Italian · Angelo Gaja — the modernizer of Piedmont</i>